EKEMINI LIRON ESSIEN

CLOUD | AI SECURITY ENGINEER

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PROFILE

Engineering and security professional with a track record securing AWS environments, implementing IAM/RBAC and policy-as-code controls, driving cloud security risk reduction, SOC2 compliance, and improving resiliency. Combines hands-on engineering with security and strong communication skills.

CERTIFICATIONS

- AWS AI Practitioner — Issued: August 2026 | Expires: August 2029
- AWS Machine Learning Associate — Issued: September 19, 2026 | Expires: September 19, 2029
- AWS Solutions Architect Associate — Issued: October 16, 2026 | Expires: October 16, 2026
- CompTIA Security+ — Issued: August 18, 2020 | Expires: August 18, 2029
- AWS Cloud Practitioner — Issued: February 23, 2022 | Expires: September 19, 2029

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Cloud & Infrastructure: AWS, EC2, ECS, S3, RDS, VPC, IAM, Route 53, CloudFront, Elastic Load Balancing, Lambda, Secrets Manager
Cloud Security: CIS, AWS Security Hub CSPM, IAM/RBAC/ABAC, least privilege, MFA, vulnerability management & remediation
DevSecOps & Automation: Terraform, CloudFormation Policy as Code, GitHub Actions, Python, AWS Lambda
Networking: VPC, route tables, VPN/OpenVPN/Site-to-Site, DNS, TLS, load balancers
Data & Platforms: Databricks, Athena, DynamoDB, RDS, MySQL, SQL/NoSQL, Alteryx, Tableau, JSON/YAML
Compliance & Privacy: SOC2, security architecture reviews, access reviews, data privacy, CCPA

EMPLOYMENT HISTORY

Tunnl — DevSecOps Engineer | April 2022 – Present

- Engineered and enforced AWS security controls across 8+ services (IAM, S3, EC2, RDS, VPC, ELB, Secrets Manager) spanning 5 organizational accounts and 9 teams, securing 100+ users while maintaining full compliance with AWS Foundational Security Best Practices and CIS AWS Foundations benchmarks.
- Built and led Tunnl's SOC 2 compliance program from inception, delivering 5 successful audit issuances across SOC 1 and SOC 2 Type I/II certifications — directly unlocking Fortune 500 client opportunities and measurably strengthening enterprise security posture.
- Drove a 22% reduction in security findings across the organization by executing continuous cloud security assessments, vulnerability remediation, and control enhancements via AWS Security Hub — achieving an average remediation time of 11 days across a multi-team engineering environment.
- Executed independent cloud security assessments, vulnerability remediation, and security-control enhancements across a multi-team engineering environment, driving continuous reduction in organizational risk exposure.
- Partnered with Platform, API, ETL, and Data teams to close systemic security gaps and harden cloud configurations, reducing recurring vulnerabilities over time while aligning remediation roadmaps with executive and business stakeholders.
- Architected Terraform and JSON policy-as-code frameworks to enforce security best practices and standardize configurations across 25 AWS organizational accounts, eliminating configuration drift at scale.
- Provisioned and administered identity and access management across AWS, Databricks, GitHub, VPN, and additional enterprise platforms — supporting 9 departments and 50+ contractors with consistent, least-privilege access controls.
- Designed and deployed a pilot-light disaster recovery environment in AWS us-west-2, establishing failover infrastructure across S3, ECS, RDS, AWS Client VPN, DNS, and application services to meet business continuity objectives.
- Automated credential rotation using AWS Lambda and Secrets Manager, reducing manual security operations and minimizing credential exposure risk across the organization.
- Spearheaded implementation of a SaaS privacy-request platform, integrating vendor APIs with AWS RDS and S3 in collaboration with Engineering, ETL, and Data teams — processing 506,000+ deletion requests, 32 access requests, and 44 opt-out requests with average completion times of under 7 hours, enabling scalable, audit-ready data subject request handling.
- Established Tunnl's third-party security assessment program, formalizing vendor risk management processes and strengthening data protection controls across upstream and downstream data partners.

Cymulate — Cyber-Risk Assessment Specialist | September 2020 – March 2022

- Drove pipeline growth by engaging enterprise security stakeholders and leveraging technical knowledge of breach and attack simulations to establish credibility and accelerate sales cycles.
- Delivered product demonstrations showcasing risk assessments across email, web gateways, and endpoints — mapping client security gaps to lateral movement and data exfiltration scenarios using CrowdStrike Falcon, Splunk, and Microsoft Defender.

- Aligned client security risks to the MITRE ATT&CK framework during discovery engagements, enabling sales engineers to tailor solutions and advance pipeline opportunities.
- Consulted enterprise security teams on cloud migration security, attack surface management, and purple-team exercises — positioning Cymulate as a strategic continuous security validation platform.

Operatix — Business Development | September 2019 – September 2020

- Generated pipeline by connecting enterprise security leaders with targeted software and cloud vendor solutions across threat intelligence, API protection, data privacy, and Salesforce security — translating complex security challenges into actionable vendor recommendations.

Globe Life — Business Development Manager | December 2017 – September 2019

- Managed a high-performing team generating an average of $500,000 in annual recurring revenue and introduced real-time goal-tracking to improve performance.

PROJECTS

Cloud Resume Deployment | March 2022

Built a cloud-hosted website with a database, API Gateway, custom domain, HTTPS, and Python 3 serverless functions, packaged using an AWS SAM template.

EDUCATION

Solent University — Southampton, England | 2016–2017

Master of Science, Management — First Class

Houston Baptist University — Houston, Texas | 2012–2016

Bachelor of Business Administration — Cum Laude